KOODAL — Privacy Policy (Draft)

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> **Draft for legal review.** Based on the KOODAL App PRD v2.4 and Backend PRD v1.5. It is not legal advice; have a lawyer qualified in India review it before publishing. Replace items in [square brackets]. Version: `2026-11-01` (must match the Privacy version recorded at sign-in).

1. Who we are

KOODAL collects only the personal data it needs to help you find people for activities in Chennai, never sells it, and lets you delete it at any time.

- KOODAL ("we", "us") is operated by [Legal entity name], Chennai, Tamil Nadu. We are the Data Fiduciary for your personal data under the Digital Personal Data Protection Act, 2023 ("DPDP Act") and the DPDP Rules, 2025.
- This policy covers the KOODAL mobile app, plan-share pages at koodal.social, and our support channels.
- It should be read with our Terms and Conditions.
- Effective date: [DD Month 2026].

2. What we collect

Data	Where it comes from	Required?
Mobile number	You, at sign-in; verified by SMS code	Yes
Consent record (Terms and Privacy versions accepted, time)	Created at sign-in	Yes
18+ confirmation	You, during profile setup	Yes
Display name	You	Before creating or joining a plan
Profile photo	You (gallery or camera)	No

Data	Where it comes from	Required?
Gender	You	No
Preferred area and interests, including "Other" text	You	No
Plans you host: activity, date, venue, people needed, note, cover photo	You	When hosting
Joins: requests, join messages, join commitment (version and time), RSVP	You	When joining
Attendance and reliability (plans attended, no-shows)	You, hosts, and app records	Created by use
Plan chat messages	You and other members	When you chat
Reports and blocks you make, and reports about you	You and other users	Created by use
Device data: device ID, platform, app version, push token, hashed IP address	Your device	Yes
Usage events (screens viewed, buttons tapped, errors)	The app	Yes
Support and grievance messages	You	When you contact us

Venue search: when you search for a venue, your search words are sent to Google Places to find public venues.

3. What we do not collect

- Your contacts or address book.
- Your home address or precise location history. You choose a general area instead.
- Your date of birth. We only ask you to confirm you are 18 or older.
- Your SMS inbox. Code autofill works without SMS read permission.
- Payment or bank details. KOODAL does not process payments.
- Location data from photos. We strip location (EXIF) data from uploaded cover photos.

4. How we use your data

We process your data on the basis of your consent, given when you sign in, and for uses the DPDP Act allows without fresh consent, such as meeting legal obligations.

Purpose	Data used
Create and secure your account, sign you in, keep you signed in	Mobile number, device data
Show you relevant plans	Area, interests
Let you host, join and chat in plans	Profile, plans, joins, chat messages
Run women-only and men-only plans	Gender
Send reminders and updates ("Still coming?", join requests, plan changes)	Push token, plans, joins
Reduce no-shows and show reliability	Join commitment, RSVP, attendance
Keep users safe: review reports, block, suspend, prevent abuse and SMS fraud	Reports, blocks, account and device data, hashed IP
Improve the app and fix problems	Usage events, error logs
Respond to support and grievance requests	Your messages, account data
Meet legal obligations and lawful requests	Any data needed for that request

We do not sell your personal data, and we do not use it for third-party advertising.

Withdrawing consent. You can withdraw consent at any time by deleting your account in Settings or by contacting us. This does not affect processing already done. We need your mobile number to run your account, so withdrawing consent ends your use of the Service.

5. What other people can see

Who	What they can see
Any KOODAL user	Your display name, profile photo, badges ("Verified phone", "Shows up"), number of plans attended and hosted, and the plans you host

Who	What they can see
Hosts of plans you request to join	The above, plus your join message and attendance record
Host and accepted members of a plan	Who else has been accepted, and messages in that plan's chat
Anyone with a share link	The plan title, activity, time, area, venue name, spots left, cover and the host's first name

We never show your mobile number, gender, preferred area or interests to other users. Users you block cannot see your profile or plans.

6. Who we share data with

We share personal data only with service providers that help us run KOODAL, under contracts that limit their use to our instructions, and with authorities when the law requires.

Provider	What they do	Data they handle
MSG91	Sends sign-in codes by SMS	Mobile number, code
[Render / Railway]	Hosts our servers	All app data
[Neon / Supabase]	Hosts our database	All app data
Cloudflare (R2)	Stores and delivers photos	Profile and cover photos
Expo, Google (FCM), Apple (APNs)	Deliver push notifications	Push token, notification text
Google Places	Venue search	Search words, venue chosen
PostHog	Product analytics	User ID, usage events (never your number, name or gender)

We may also disclose data to police, courts or government agencies when required by law, or to protect someone's safety. If KOODAL is merged or sold, your data may transfer to the new owner under this policy.

7. Where your data is stored

We store data in the region closest to India that each provider offers, such as Mumbai or Singapore. Some providers may process data in other countries. We transfer data outside India only as the DPDP Act and any government restrictions allow, and we require providers to protect it.

8. How long we keep it

Data	Kept for
Profile, plans, joins, attendance	While your account is active
Sign-in codes (stored only in hashed form)	24 hours
Login sessions	30 days after they expire or you log out
Uploaded photos never attached to a plan	24 hours
Reports and moderation records	2 years
Support and grievance messages	[2 years]
Usage analytics	[12 months]

When you delete your account, we cancel your hosted upcoming plans, remove you from plans you joined, end your sessions, and delete your photo, mobile number, name, gender, area and interests. We keep an anonymised record of past plans and reports for safety and legal reasons. The same number can be used to sign up again.

9. Your rights and choices

Under the DPDP Act you can:

- **Access** a summary of the personal data we hold about you and how we use it.
- **Correct or update** your data. Most of it you can edit in the app.
- **Erase** your data by deleting your account in Settings, or by asking us.
- **Withdraw consent** at any time (section 4).
- **Nominate** a person to exercise your rights if you die or become unable to.

- **Raise a grievance** with us (section 13), and if not satisfied, complain to the Data Protection Board of India.

In-app choices: turn off notifications in your phone settings, skip optional fields, block users, and leave plans.

To use these rights, email us from the app or at the address in section 13. We may ask you to confirm your mobile number to verify it is you, and we respond within the time the law requires.

10. Security

- All data travels over HTTPS.
- Sign-in codes and session tokens are stored only in hashed form, and IP addresses are hashed.
- Mobile numbers, codes and tokens are removed from our logs and never sent to analytics.
- Access to production data is limited to the people who need it.
- Photos are stored privately and served through our CDN.

No system is perfectly secure. If a personal data breach affects you, we will inform you and the Data Protection Board of India as the DPDP Act and Rules require, and tell you what we are doing about it.

11. Children

KOODAL is only for people aged 18 and over. We do not knowingly collect data from anyone under 18. If we learn an account belongs to someone under 18, we delete it. If you believe a child is using KOODAL, contact us.

12. Changes to this policy

We may update this policy as KOODAL changes or the law changes. For material changes, we will notify you in the app and ask you to accept the new version before you continue. The version you accepted and when are recorded.

13. Contact and grievances

For privacy questions, data requests or complaints, contact our Grievance Officer:

Detail	Value
Name	Mohanraj Murugesan
Email	mohan@koodal.social
Address	Chennai, Tamil Nadu
Hours	All days, 10:00 to 19:00 IST

General support: support@koodal.social. If you are not satisfied with our response, you can complain to the Data Protection Board of India.